Senior Project Manager (Waste Management Infrastructure)

Location Dushanbe, Tajikistan
Sector Non Profit
Experience Mid Career
Posted Jun 16
Location Type Onsite

Position description

Lead and manage impactful infrastructure projects from inception to delivery, ensuring success across diverse sectors.

Under the GEF funded project 9421 “Demonstration of non-thermal treatment of DDT wastes in Central Asia”, led by the UN Environment Programme (UNEP) and with) with UNEP’s GEF Unit as Implementing Agency (IA) and UNEP’s Europe Office as Executing Agency (EA) and UNOPS as technical implementation, tendering and procurement partner, the dedicated UNOPS project aims to strengthen national and regional capacities for managing hazardous waste — particularly DDT and other persistent organic pollutants (POP) — following the guidelines of the Basel and Stockholm Conventions. In specific, UNOPS will be working on the design and construction of containment works in selected sites in Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan as well as on the procurement of related goods and services for the sites, in order for POP waste to be bio-remediated as project output.

The Senior Project Manager (Infrastructure) is responsible for the effective delivery and day-to-day management of this project, which involves the construction of physical assets, technical outputs, or both. The Senior Project Manager serves as the focal point for coordination with donors, partners and beneficiaries, ensuring alignment with contractual commitments and UNOPS performance standards. Acting on behalf of the Project Board, the Senior Project Manager ensures that project outputs are delivered within agreed tolerances of time, cost, scope, quality, risk, and benefits. The Senior Project Manager reports to the Head of Programme, AUMCO.

1. Project Delivery and Performance

Develop, complete and update the project implementation plan.
Implement the approved plan (including establishment of milestones) within tolerances set by the Project Board, including the development of infrastructure designs and coordinating design reviews.
Embed sustainability dimensions, including social and gender considerations, and environmental and economic aspects, into the project life span.
Manage the production of required outputs, taking responsibility for overall progress and use of resources while initiating corrective action where necessary.
Ensure that quality of work packages and deliverables comply with the quality requirements defined in the implementation plan.
Liaise with external suppliers or account managers to ensure quality and timely delivery of outputs. Manage acceptance and delivery of work packages.
Monitor project progress, control project variances (if any), and manage changes.
Identify, anticipate and advise senior management and the project board on mitigating measures against project risks to ensure that benefits to partners and other stakeholders are maximized.
Identify and report potential opportunities for UNOPS to the supervisor

2. Procedures

Comply with the organization’s policies and standards, and ensure project information is kept updated in project management systems.
Be aware of applicable local laws and regulations, and ensure adherence. This includes international regulations and standards, where applicable, as well as technical standards.
Prepare and adapt all relevant plans for approval by the project board, and manage baselines
Manage the reporting obligations defined in the implementation plan and legal agreements.
Maintain project documentation in an orderly manner for accessibility and audit support when needed.
Understand and apply the UNOPS financial rules and regulations. Be accountable for the use of delegation of authority (where applicable) and ensure compliance with relevant policies and standards of ethics.
Provide a formal handover of the project to the closure manager when applicable.

Support project audit activities, including planning, preparation and coordination during audits and follow-up on audit observations/ recommendations.

3. Monitoring and Reporting

Include a results framework and M&E plan in the project implementation plan with clearly defined indicators and agreed targets, ensure regular monitoring and tracking of project results.
Prepare and issue regular project and financial reports in accordance with partner and UNOPS requirements for reporting.
Regularly review project status and evaluate performance criteria (scope, cost, schedule, and quality)
Maintain diaries and progress reports as required by UNOPS standard operating procedures.
Provide routine oversight and analysis of delivery data within the dashboard system.
Ensure all project team members track and regularly update milestones and targets for the duration of the project life span.
Ensure full traceability and chain of custody for all contaminated soil, debris, and pure pesticide waste, from the site of origin to the final disposal cell at Vakhsh and Suzak A Landfills, including all necessary weighing and documentation certificates.

4. Stakeholder Engagement

Develop stakeholder engagement strategies and plans. Actively engage stakeholders, take feedback, and adjust as necessary.
Establish solid working relationships with the project board (executive, senior users and senior suppliers); clients; and key stakeholders.
Enable formulation of project communication plans and monitor effectiveness of project communications.
Coordinate stakeholder engagement and communication, ensuring effective timing and interdependency management of communications. Ensure stakeholders are aware of project activities, progress, and exceptions, and are in a position to accept handover outputs.
The PM will coordinate and oversee the implementation of the Ambient Environmental Monitoring framework (including air quality and odor monitoring) and

manage structured engagement with nearby communities to mitigate potential off-site effects and manage local perception.
The PM will serve as the principal UNOPS representative to the GEF 9421 Project Steering Committee

5. Quality Assurance

Work with internal stakeholders to ensure projects comply with audit requirements.
Work with procurement/ purchasing personnel to ensure effective interface with suppliers' quality systems.
Coordinate quality reviews of project documents and deliverables.
Provide quality control for management outputs (e.g. project documents, reports, etc)

6. Knowledge Management and Innovation

Actively interact with other project managers and the wider project management (PM) community, share case studies, lessons learned and best practices.
Stay abreast with latest updates and good practices of the profession, participate in training and learning activities for self to advance proficiency and competency.
Ensure lessons learned are shared in a timely and appropriate manner.
Provide feedback to corporate practice groups on policy and systems, when needed.
Provide feedback to functional groups on policies and related guidance to support the continuous improvement of UNOPS policy framework.

7.Personnel Management

Organise and structure the project team, ensure clearly defined roles and responsibilities. Provide regular guidance and direction, as needed, and support the team in effectively performing their tasks.
Lead and motivate the project management team, and manage performance.
Ensure performance reviews are conducted fairly, accurately, and on time.

Select, recruit, and train project teams as required, taking gender parity and diversity objectives into account.
Ensure safety and security for all project personnel in compliance with the UN Department of Safety and Security (UNDSS) standards